

TRUSTMRR // MARKET INTELLIGENCE

State of the Indie & Micro-SaaS Economy

A data-driven read on 1,000 revenue-verified startups — how they monetize, who gets users, and which domains are winning.

Snapshot frozen 30 Jul 2026 · 1,000 startups · 29 data fields per company

What TrustMRR Is — and What This Deck Uses

TrustMRR is a public directory of startups that link live payment providers (Stripe, RevenueCat, Polar, Dodo, Paddle, etc.) to display verified — not self-reported — revenue and MRR.

This analysis uses a frozen snapshot of the dataset to understand category dynamics, monetization patterns, user acquisition, and website/domain strength across the panel.

1,000

Startups in the frozen snapshot

29

Data fields per company

871

Publicly named companies

129

Operating in stealth mode

Fields captured: revenue history (30d / 3m / 12m / all-time), MRR & growth, active subscriptions, traffic, positioning (value prop, persona, pricing), payment provider, domain rating, and M&A status.

Data frozen 30 Jul 2026. Self-selected sample of startups that opt into TrustMRR verification — directional, not a census of the market.

A Long Tail of Small, Sticky Businesses

— *with a thin layer of real winners on top.*

\$13.5M

combined MRR across the panel

\$282

median company MRR — a power-law market

19.7%

of startups report \$0 MRR

21%

of companies clear \$10K MRR

58%

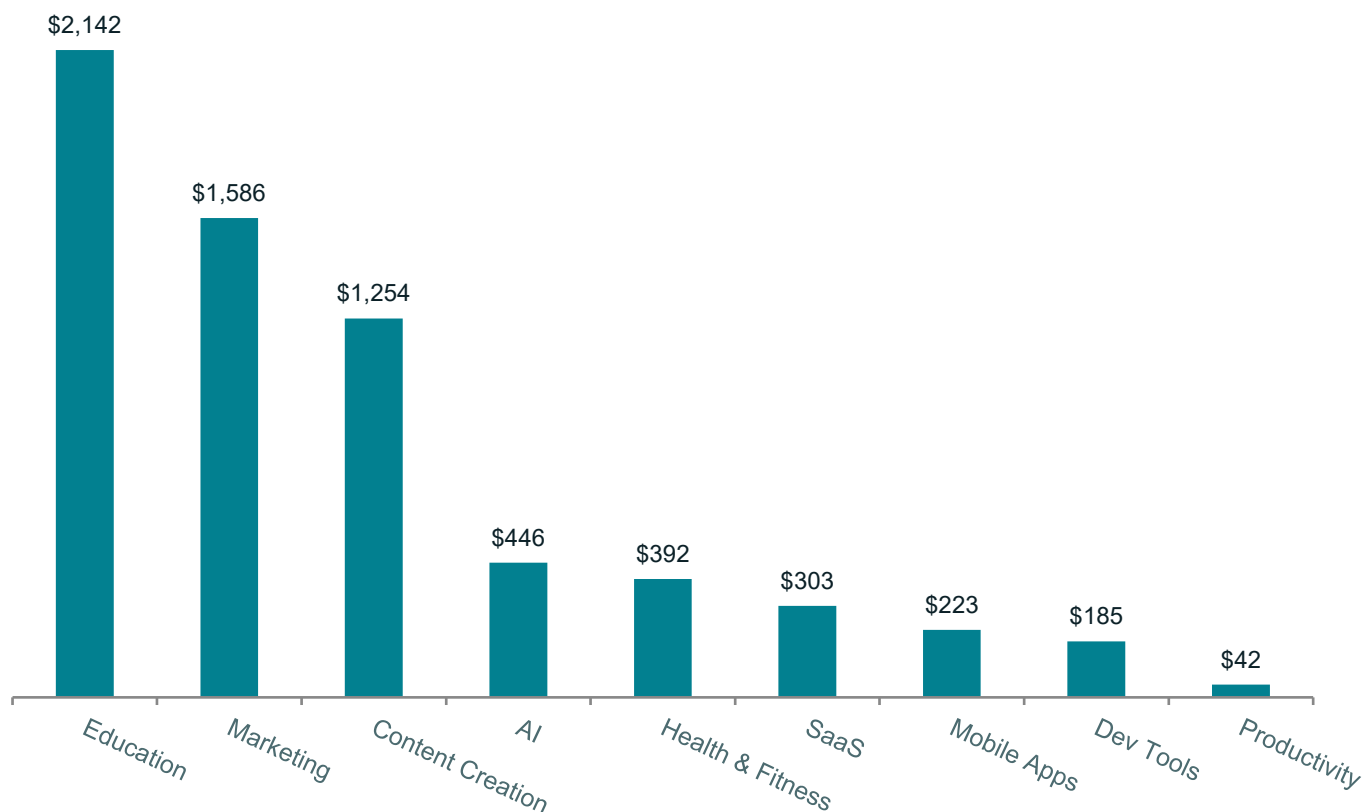
of all panel MRR comes from B2B, though B2B is only 26% of companies

27%

of AI startups are listed for sale — the highest of any major category

Everyone's Building AI. Few Are Building Revenue.

Median MRR by Category (USD)



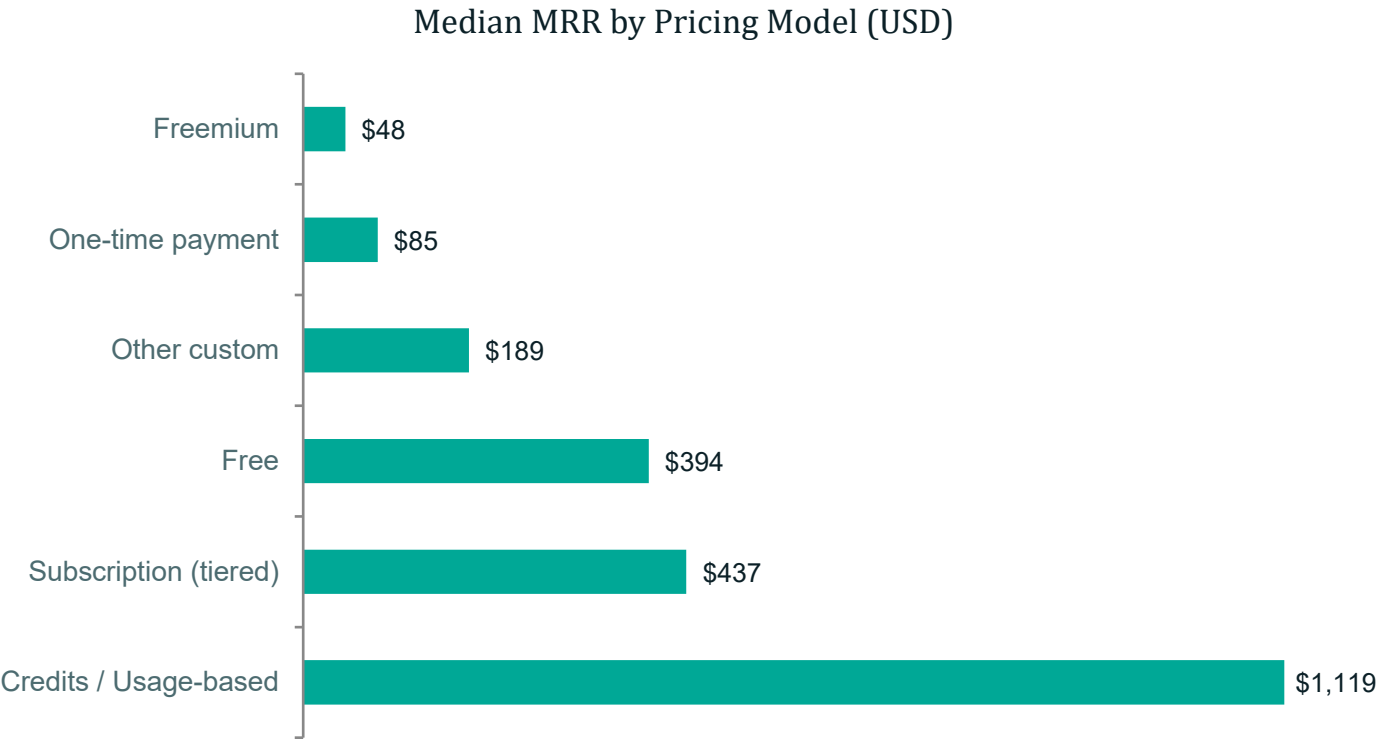
197 AI startups — 20% of the whole panel — but only \$446 median MRR.

Smaller categories like Education, Marketing, and Content Creation monetize far better per company than the crowded AI / SaaS / Mobile Apps segments.

Takeaway

Category crowding does not equal category profitability. The best risk-adjusted bets sit in mid-size, under-hyped verticals — not the loudest one.

Subscriptions Rule — Usage-Based Pricing Quietly Wins



Payment rails in use

Stripe (636 companies) · RevenueCat (189, mobile-first) · Dodo Payments (50) · Polar (36) · Lemon Squeezy (25) · Paddle (16)

Key reads

- 1 Credit / usage-based pricing out-earns every other model — pay-as-you-grow captures more value than flat tiers.
- 2 Freemium converts worst in this panel: lowest median MRR of any classified pricing model.
- 3 Stripe is the default rail; RevenueCat dominates mobile-subscription apps specifically.

Followers Don't Pay the Bills — B2B Does



Fastest-growing startups (30-day MRR growth, real revenue base)

Company	Category	30d MRR Growth	Audience
SetupClaw.xyz	SaaS	+3,885%	B2C
Hidden Jobs	Recruiting & HR	+1,357%	B2C
HotelHero.ai	AI	+1,227%	B2B
Hong Xuan Kow	AI	+459%	Both
Kickly	Games	+385%	B2C

Takeaway

X-follower count correlates only weakly with MRR ($r \approx 0.34$). Traffic quality and pricing power predict revenue far better than audience size.

Domain Authority Is the Cleanest Signal in the Data

Median MRR by Domain Rating Tier (USD)



$r \approx 0.45$

correlation between domain rating and MRR
— the strongest single relationship found in the dataset.

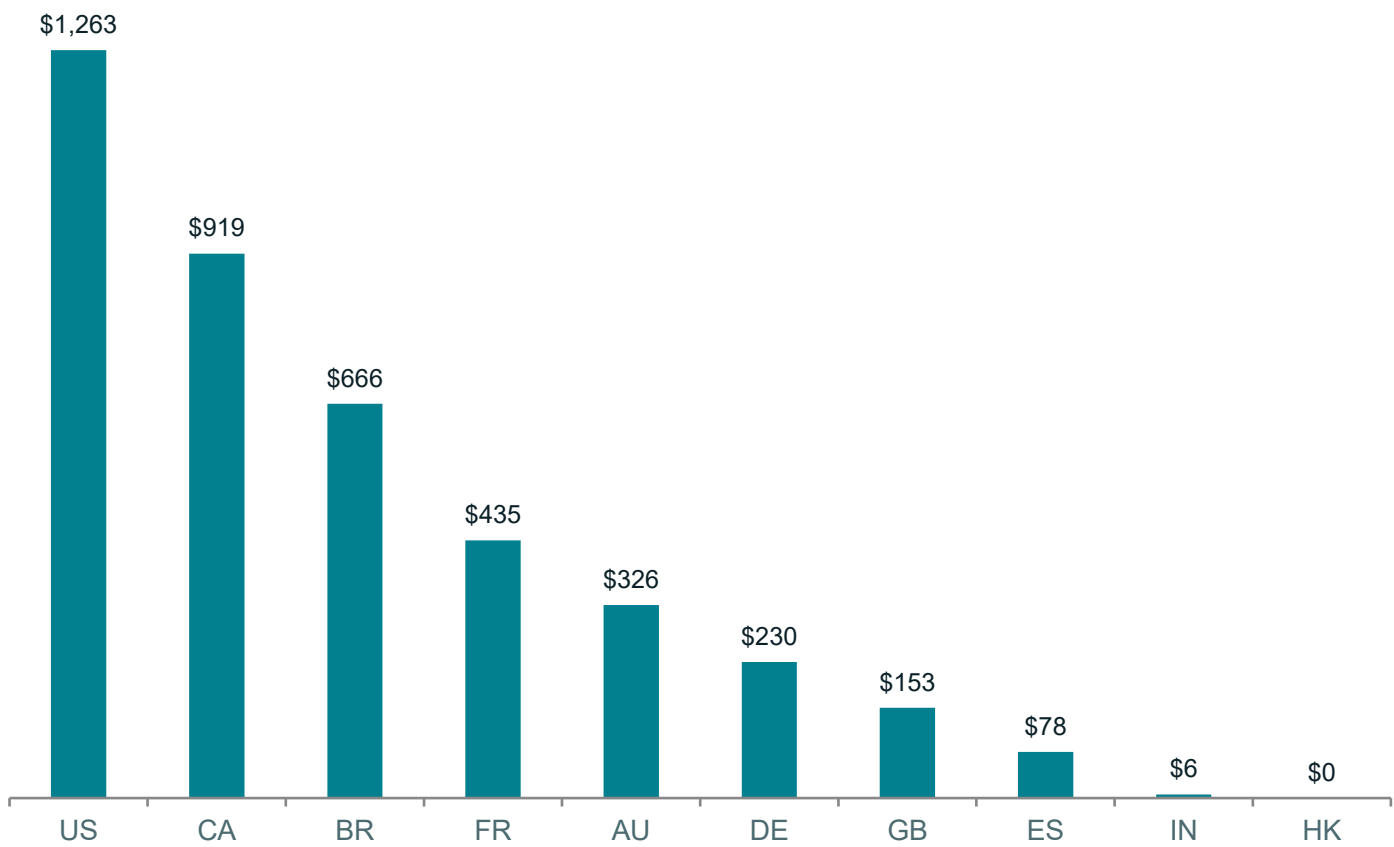
157

companies with zero domain authority —
sitting at ~\$9 median MRR, essentially pre-revenue.

*SEO and content investment isn't vanity
— it's a leading indicator of monetization.*

The US Wins on Both Volume and Quality

Median MRR by Country, Top 10 by Count (USD)



Reads by market

- US** 258 companies, \$1,263 median — biggest market and one of the best-monetized.
- FR** 79 companies, \$435 median — largest non-US market, solid mid-tier monetization.
- IN** 59 companies, just \$6 median — high builder activity, weak local monetization.
- HK** \$0 median but high mean — a handful of outliers skew the average.

One in Five Companies Is Effectively Pre-Revenue

Top companies by MRR

Company	Category	Country	MRR	Audience
Stan	—	US	\$3.57M	—
GojiberryAI	AI	US	\$494.7K	B2B
Rezi	AI	US	\$259.7K	B2C
Kibu	Education	US	\$234.3K	B2B
Cometly	Analytics	US	\$207.6K	B2B
1Lookup	SaaS	US	\$207.1K	B2B
Postiz	Social Media	HK	\$177.1K	B2B

Note: most top earners skew B2B, despite B2C being the majority of companies overall.

19.7%

of all companies (197) report \$0 MRR — a large stalled / pre-launch tail.

21%

of companies (212) have crossed \$10K MRR — a reasonable bar for "real business" status.

26%

of companies have stalled to zero revenue *or* are already listed for sale — see next slide.

A Quarter of This Ecosystem Is Already For Sale

26.2%

of all startups are flagged on sale

\$35K

median asking price (mean \$332K, up to \$10M)

~38x

median asking price as a multiple of monthly MRR

27%

of AI startups specifically are on sale — the highest share of any major category

Multiples range widely (25th pct ≈ 22x, 75th pct ≈ 70x MRR) — pricing in this micro-M&A market is inconsistent, leaving room for informed buyers.

Build Boring, Monetize Aggressively

— *and don't chase followers.*

1

Pricing model beats category choice

Usage-based / credit pricing consistently out-earns subscriptions and freemium, regardless of vertical.

2

B2B is still the better business

Fewer companies, but 58% of all panel MRR — better monetization per company than B2C.

3

Domain authority is worth investing in early

The strongest single correlate of revenue found in the data ($r \approx 0.45$ with MRR).

4

AI is crowded and commoditizing

Highest founder activity, highest share on sale (27%), flat median growth — differentiation will decide winners, not category.

5

The secondary market is inefficient

Wide multiple dispersion (22x–70x MRR) signals real opportunity for informed buyers.

Methodology Notes

Small print, but it matters.

1

Snapshot frozen 30 Jul 2026. This is a self-selected sample of startups that opt into TrustMRR verification — likely skews toward solo/indie builders rather than enterprise SaaS.

2

Significant missingness in category (274 blank), pricing model (343 blank), and traffic fields (visitors_30d missing for 822 of 1,000 rows) — treat traffic-based conclusions as directional.

3

"Stealth Company" listings (129 records) obscure identity/category for some of the largest MRR outliers, including the #2 and #4 companies by MRR. Included in aggregate stats; excluded from named-company rankings.

4

All medians used in preference to means throughout this deck, given the extreme right-skew of revenue and MRR across the panel.